



Providing Creative Solutions to Common Problems

REVENUE-CYCLE RECOVERY · CAPABILITIES OVERVIEW

Debt Collection Agency for Businesses

Recovering patient balances and stalled surgical claims for Metropolitan Houston Surgery Associates — compliantly, on pure contingency

Prepared for **Metropolitan Houston Surgery Associates** · July 2026

The recovery layer for what your billing process couldn't close

Prepared for Metropolitan Houston Surgery Associates — for a surgical practice, net revenue leaks at the end of the revenue cycle: in the patient responsibility that surgery leaves behind, the self-pay and cash-procedure balances, and the denied, underpaid or prior-auth-stalled claims that survive billing and age past the point your office can work them.

This is the last stage of the revenue cycle, not the first. Coding, claim submission and adjudication are your billing team's job; the balances that survive that process are where net revenue quietly leaks. A patient balance worked at 60 days resolves at a far higher rate than the same balance at 300.

Southwest Recovery Services is the recovery layer that works those balances — patient A/R, insurance follow-up and bad debt — HIPAA-compliant and on pure contingency since 2004. We resolve what billing couldn't: no retainer, no setup fee, no recovery no fee. We complement your billing; we do not replace it.

Two decades of receivables recovery — nationwide, HIPAA-compliant

The recovery capacity a busy surgical practice can plug in without hiring for it — documented, compliance-first, and paid only on results.

2004 Recovering commercial receivables since	\$975M+ Receivables placed (all industries)	\$76M+ Recovered for clients	800K+ Accounts worked
52% of placed accounts see a recovery	50 states — nationwide recovery reach	4.9★ Google client rating	\$0 upfront — no recovery, no fee

Commercial & B2B collections since 2004

Nationwide — all 50 states

12 offices across 7 states

Skip tracing on businesses & principals

Contingency — no recovery, no fee

RECOGNIZED & FEATURED BY

[USA Today](#) [Financial Services Review — Top AR Management Service 2025](#)

[insideARM — 10× ROI](#) [CFO Tech Outlook — Top 10](#) [International Business Times](#)

ACCREDITED & RECOGNIZED



What a practice's billing office asks us

The questions that matter when the goal is recovering net revenue, not running billing.

YOUR QUESTION	SOUTHWEST RECOVERY SERVICES
Fee structure	Pure contingency — \$0 upfront, no retainer, no setup or per-account fee. You pay a percentage only of what we actually recover, so it's a variable-cost backstop to your revenue cycle.
What we recover	We're the recovery layer, not billing: post-insurance patient responsibility (surgical deductibles, coinsurance, copays), self-pay and cash-procedure balances, aged guarantor balances, and denied, underpaid or pending claims — including prior-auth-heavy bariatric and elective cases — resolving what the billing process could not.
Insurance follow-up & appeals	We track each payer's filing and appeal deadlines, follow the required resolution path, and escalate before the recovery window closes — recovering earned net revenue that stalled on the claim side, including medical-necessity and prior-authorization denials.
Early-out & recovery timing	A balance worked at 60 days resolves far higher than at 300. Early-out (30–90 days) plus prompt bad-debt placement recover materially more than balances left to sit; outreach begins within 24–48 hours.
Compliance	HIPAA under a Business Associate Agreement (minimum-necessary PHI); FDCPA / Reg F on patient accounts; current on evolving state medical-debt credit-reporting rules — furnishing only where lawful.
Onboarding & placement	Bulk-upload a patient-AR / aging export from your practice-management system through our secure portal; we map your columns, no re-keying — a backstop to your billing, not a replacement.

Low-lift intake and full visibility, on demand

Every placement is managed through our secure portal — built to take your patient-AR / aging exports and give your team live, self-service access throughout recovery, backed by a dedicated account manager.

SYSTEM-READY PLACEMENT

Bulk-upload a patient-AR / aging export from your practice-management or billing system (CSV/Excel) — we map your columns, no re-keying.

REAL-TIME REPORTING

Run and export account and recovery reports on demand — a live dashboard, not a monthly summary.

SECURE FILE EXCHANGE

Send EOBs, statements and supporting records safely inside the portal under our BAA, not over email.

DIRECT-PAYMENT REPORTING

Log payments a patient makes directly to you, so balances stay accurate and no one is over-contacted.

► **Portal Video Tour**

SWRS Healthcare Recovery Case Studies

Actual placed-versus-recovered results from Southwest Recovery's healthcare book, anonymized by sub-sector. Patient/aged balances recover lower than commercial — timing and skip tracing move the number.

SPECIALTY PHYSICIAN GROUP

Multi-site specialty practice

\$90K recovered

of ~\$464K placed

19% recovered

SKILLED NURSING & REHAB

Long-term care center

\$104K recovered

of ~\$559K placed

19% recovered

PAIN & NEUROLOGY CLINIC

Outpatient specialty

\$33K recovered

of ~\$453K placed

7% recovered

PHARMACY SERVICES

Retail & specialty pharmacy

\$50K recovered

of ~\$520K placed

10% recovered

HOME HEALTH AGENCY

In-home care provider

\$35K recovered

of ~\$474K placed

7% recovered

PRIMARY CARE GROUP

Multi-provider clinic

\$28K recovered

of ~\$557K placed

5% recovered

Anonymized by sector from Southwest Recovery's book; individual client names withheld. Results vary by account age, balance, documentation quality and industry. We do not publish blended portfolio averages.

THE EARLY-OUT ADVANTAGE**Why early placement recovers more**

For patient AR, the age of the balance is the strongest predictor of recovery — contact data goes cold and patients disengage as accounts age.

THE AGE CURVE

Fresh balances recover a large multiple of aged ones; the decline is steep and does not reverse.

EARLY-OUT + BAD DEBT

An early-out program on fresh balances plus prompt bad-debt placement, worked in parallel, recovers materially more than a single late hand-off.

We speak revenue cycle

Surgical patient and payer AR has a specific recovery profile. Our playbook is built for it, inside HIPAA.



Surgical patient responsibility

Compliant, professional recovery of post-insurance deductibles and coinsurance that protects the patient relationship.



Denied & stalled claims

Insurance follow-up and appeals on medical-necessity and prior-auth denials common to bariatric and elective surgery.



Self-pay & cash procedures

Recovery of self-pay and cash-procedure balances that age out of the practice's reach.



Compliance-first

HIPAA + FDCPA / Reg F on every account, current on state medical-debt rules.

Recovery run on an AI-driven platform — Aktos

Every account SWRS works runs on Aktos, a next-generation, AI-driven collections platform — with compliance built into the workflow, not bolted on afterward. It's how a boutique, people-first agency delivers enterprise-grade speed, consistency, and auditability.



AI workflow automation

Repetitive steps are automated and every account is scored and routed by predicted payment likelihood — so the right strategy reaches the right account first, without manual queue-picking.



Omnichannel outreach

Coordinated email, SMS, and voice, timed to when a debtor is most likely to engage — replacing high-friction call blasts with respectful, data-driven contact.



Compliance built in

FDCPA, Reg F, and TCPA guardrails are enforced inside the automation, with phone-number and consent checks before outreach — documented and defensible on every account.



Real-time dashboards

You see status, segmentation, and recovery performance on your portfolio in real time — full transparency, not a monthly PDF.



API-first intake

Secure SFTP/API placement means accounts start working without data lag — roughly 50% faster acknowledgment and validation of new placements.



Data-driven scoring

Dynamic scoring and segmentation predict payment likelihood and concentrate effort where recovery is most achievable — earlier intervention that trims DSO and reduces disputes.

The result is the combination clients rarely get from a legacy agency: faster cash and cleaner compliance at the same time. Automation accelerates recovery and standardizes documentation, while empathy-first, data-driven contact protects your brand and keeps disputes and complaints low.

Built by a collector with 30 years on the phones — not a CEO with zero collection experience



Steven Dietz

Founder & Chief Executive Officer

Featured in USA Today, International Business Times & Financial Services Review — Top AR Management Service, 2025 · ACA International member.

Steven Dietz didn't come to collections from the corner office — he came from the phones. He started as a collector and credit analyst before he was 20, was tapped by Aaron's to train collectors across 100+ locations, and has spent nearly 30 years in receivables. Along the way he became convinced the industry's bad reputation was a choice, not a requirement: businesses get paid faster when recovery is built on listening and respect rather than aggressive calls and empty threats.

He founded Southwest Recovery Services in 2004 on that principle — a national, family-owned receivables partner that treats every debtor as a person and every client relationship as worth protecting. Two decades later he still coaches the teams and works accounts personally — an operator who has actually done the job, not a manager who has only overseen it.

“Regardless of the means of recovery, our focus is always on preserving goodwill and representing the client professionally.”

— Steven Dietz, Founder & Chief Executive Officer, Southwest Recovery Services

In healthcare, recovery has to preserve the patient relationship and represent Metropolitan Houston Surgery Associates professionally — firm, compliant,

and never harassing. That protects your reputation as much as it recovers the balance.

Take it with you

Download this overview and the supporting white papers to share with your team.



Capabilities overview

PDF · prepared for
Metropolitan Houston Surgery
Associates

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The Recovery Waterfall

Our collection process · PDF

[Download PDF ↓](#)



Recovering Patient A/R

Early-out & bad debt · PDF

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Medical Debt Collection Compliance

HIPAA / FDCPA / state rules ·
PDF

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The Experian Intelligence Advantage

Data-first recovery · PDF

[Download PDF ↓](#)



The Aktos Advantage

AI-powered collections · PDF

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Let's turn aged patient balances back into cash.

A 30-minute call to walk your patient-AR file and put a contingency rate against a representative sample.

[Book a 30-minute discovery call →](#)

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12 offices across 7 states • nationwide recovery. Private & confidential — prepared for Metropolitan Houston Surgery Associates. FDCA / CFPB / FCRA compliant • ACA International member.